

Nisarg Patel

Ph.D. candidate

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Education

PhD	University of Southern California , Comparative Studies in Literature and Culture • Comparative Media and Culture	California, USA 2021 – present
Master of Arts	University of Toronto , Comparative Literature • GPA 3.97/4.00	Ontario, Canada 2019 – 2020
Bachelor of Arts (Honors)	University of Toronto , English Literature (major), Cinema Studies (minor), Literary Theory and Criticism (minor) • GPA 3.74/4.00	Ontario, Canada 2016 – 2019
Bachelor of Arts	Indira Gandhi Open University , Philosophy • First Class	India 2013 – 2016
Bachelor of Engineering	Gujarat Technological University , Production Engineering • GPA 8.14/10.00	Gujarat, India 2012 – 2013

Awards

Silver Medal, Outstanding Academic Achievement St. Michael's College, University of Toronto	2019
Dr. Michael Lutsky Undergraduate Award in Humanities Jackman Humanities Institute, University of Toronto	2018-2019
Dean's List of Scholars University of Toronto	2016-2019
Research Award for Outstanding Engineering Project Birla Vishwakarma Mahavidyalaya	2016

Conference Presentations

Writing After Amnesia: The Narratives of History between G.N. Devy and Qurratulain Hyder: ACLA Annual Conference, 2025-2026; Seminar Organizer: Uses and Abuses of History in Literary Narratives

To See a World in a Frame of an Image: Stereoscopes and Colonial Life-Worlds [Lebenswelt] of British India: Annual Conference on South Asia, U. Wisconsin-Madison, 2025-2026

Between Two Deaths: The Work of Silence in the Thought of Ranajit Guha and Gayatri Spivak: CSLC Annual Graduate Student Symposium, USC, 2025-2026

Visions of Pasts, Fictions of History: Winter Workshop on Photography, Universität Tübingen, 2024-2025

Witnessing Empire: Stereoscopes and the 1857 Mutiny in British India: Media Fields Journal Biennial IX Conference, 2024-2025

Ancient Myths, Modern Markets: Summer Workshop on South Asian Literature, Universität Tübingen, 2022-2023

Nationalist Ideologies in the Time of Transnational Cinema: CARGC Symposium, University of Pennsylvania, 2022-2023

हमारे अपनो को जगाना है: Bollywood's Histories in the Time of Hindu Nationalism: SAGSC XX, University of Chicago, 2022-2023

After-Images of Pre-Colonial India: NYU Cinema Studies Conference, NYU, 2022-2023

मेरे पास माँ है: Material and Sentimental Excess in Visual Cultures of Post-Colonial India: First Forum, USC, 2021-2022

Hello, Hello, Ji: Networks of Sociality and Commodity in Post-Colonial India: Annual Conference on South Asia, U. Wisconsin-Madison, 2021-2022

Expert Yogis, Impotent Men, Depressed Wives: Social Life of Sexual Tonics in Late Colonial India: CSLC Graduate Symposium, USC, 2021-2022

Making Space, Indulging Fantasies: Studio Photo in Colonial and Post-Colonial India: Annual South Asian Studies Conference, University of Chicago, 2021-2022

Glimpse of an Old Home: On Hermeneutics of Colonial-gaze and the Gaze of Colonial-Hermeneutics: Research-Fellow Presentation, Jackman Humanities Institute, UofT

Fellowships

Graduate School Summer Research and Writing Grant: USC, 2026 Summer

Graduate Scholar, Society of Fellows in Humanities: Levan Institute of Humanities, USC, 2025-2026

Teresa Wilson Endowed Fellowship: USC, 2025-2026

VSGC Summer Research Fellowship: VSRI, USC, 2025 Summer

Salz Pollak Pollak Research Fellowship: USC, 2024-2025

VSGC Summer Research Fellowship: VSRI, USC, 2024 Summer

CSLC Summer Research Fellowship,: CSLC, USC, 2024 Summer

NEH/VSRI Images out of Time Graduate Fellow: VSRI, USC, 2023-2024

USC-LACMA Summer Research Fellowship,: VSRI and CSLC, USC, 2023 Summer

PhD Academy Scholarship and Research Fund,: Dornsife PhD Academy, USC, 2022-2026

GSG Professional Development Fund,: Graduate Student Government, USC, 2022-2026

Graduate Research Fellowship,: East Asian Studies, University of Toronto, 2020

Center for Comparative Literature Graduate Program Award,: University of Toronto, 2019-2020

Writers-in-Residence Fellowship for Creative Writing,: Massey College, University of Toronto, 2019-2020

Undergraduate Research Fellowship,: Jackman Humanities Institute, University of Toronto, 2018-2019

Publications

Zur Elektrodynamik bewegter Körper

It concerned an interpretation of the Michelson–Morley experiment and the properties of light and time. Special relativity incorporates the principle that the speed of light is the same for all inertial observers regardless of the state of motion of the source.

Albert Einstein

en.wikisource.org/wiki/Translation:On_the_Electrodynamics_of_Moving_Bodies

Über einen die Erzeugung und Verwandlung des Lichtes betreffenden heuristischen Gesichtspunkt

In the second paper, he applied the quantum theory to light to explain the photoelectric effect. In particular, he used the idea of light quanta (photons) to explain experimental results, but stressed the importance of the experimental results. The importance of his work on the photoelectric effect earned him the Nobel Prize in Physics in 1921.

Albert Einstein

de.wikisource.org/wiki/%C3%9Cber_einen_die_Erzeugung_und_Verwandlung_des_Lichtes_betreffenden_heuristischen_Gesichtspunkt

Die Grundlage der allgemeinen Relativitätstheorie

The publication of the theory of general relativity made him internationally famous. He was professor of physics at the universities of Zurich (1909–1911) and Prague (1911–1912), before he returned to ETH Zurich (1912–1914).

Albert Einstein

de.wikisource.org/wiki/Die_Grundlage_der_allgemeinen_Relativit%C3%A4tstheorie

Teaching Experience

On Location, The Place of Literature in Global Culture: 2023-2024, Teaching Assistant

Introduction to Sociology: 2023-2024, Teaching Assistant

On Location, The Place of Literature in Global Culture: 2022-2023, Teaching Assistant

Cultures of Latin America: 2022-2023, Teaching Assistant

Languages

Hindi

Native speaker

Gujarati

Native speaker

English

Full Proficiency

French

Intermediate Proficiency

Interests

Fields

Certificates

Certificate in Communication, Leadership, and Management	2025
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Visual Studies Graduate Certificate	2024
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Center for Excellence in Teaching Certificate	2024
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Projects

Theory Today

2024 – present

'Theory Today' working group aims primarily to read and discuss the diverse range of trends within contemporary theory. From Psychoanalysis to contemporary interventions within Marxism, Postcolonial thought, Media Theory, and Gender and Sexuality studies, this group engages with recently published monographs and essays from various fields and backgrounds that are actively shaping contemporary theoretical discourse.

References

Professor Neetu Khanna, University of Southern California

Professor Priya Jaikumar, University of Southern California

Professor Panivong Norindr, University of Southern California

Professor Vanessa Schwartz, University of Southern California

Professor Ronald Mendoza-de Jesús, Emory University